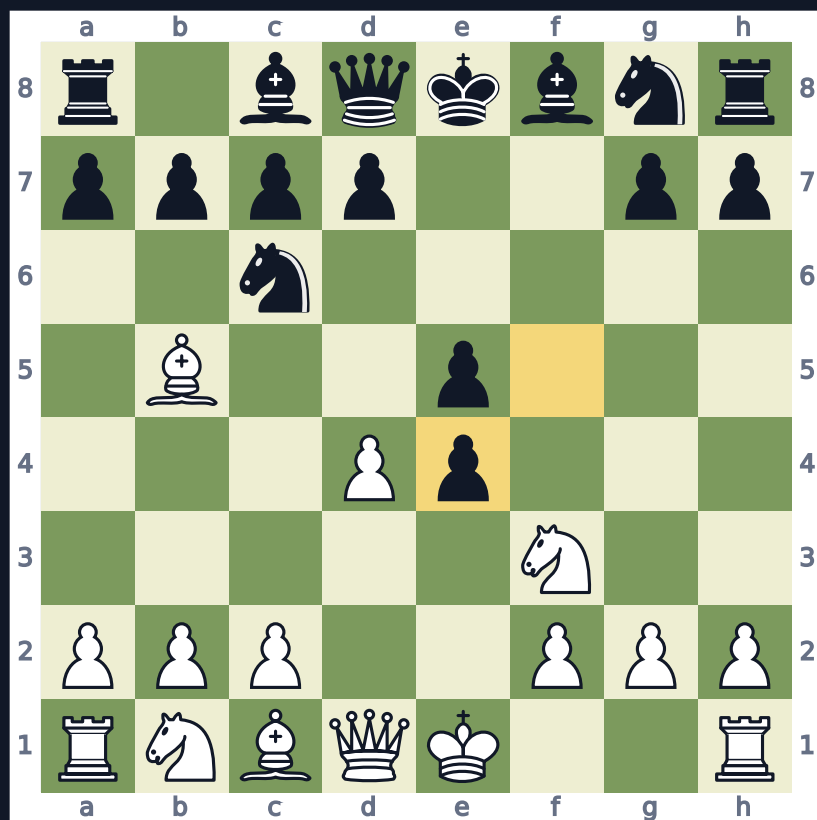


14

Schliemann, Bird, and Classical Defenses

Three off-main-road choices and the strategic price each pays for surprise or activity.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will meet and use rare defenses with principled calculation rather than trap hunting.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate candidates for the side to move, identify the opponent's strongest resource, and choose the resulting structure you can explain. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 079 | PAGE 4

Decode: Schliemann 3...f5*A gambit defense succeeds through activity; if development stops, the weaknesses remain.*

LESSON 080 | PAGE 8

Play: Schliemann 3...f5*A gambit defense succeeds through activity; if development stops, the weaknesses remain.*

LESSON 081 | PAGE 12

Decode: Bird Defense 3...Nd4*An advanced central pawn must restrict pieces or open lines; otherwise it is a target.*

LESSON 082 | PAGE 16

Play: Bird Defense 3...Nd4*An advanced central pawn must restrict pieces or open lines; otherwise it is a target.*

LESSON 083 | PAGE 20

Decode: Classical 3...Bc5*Active development must anticipate the pawn moves that attack it.*

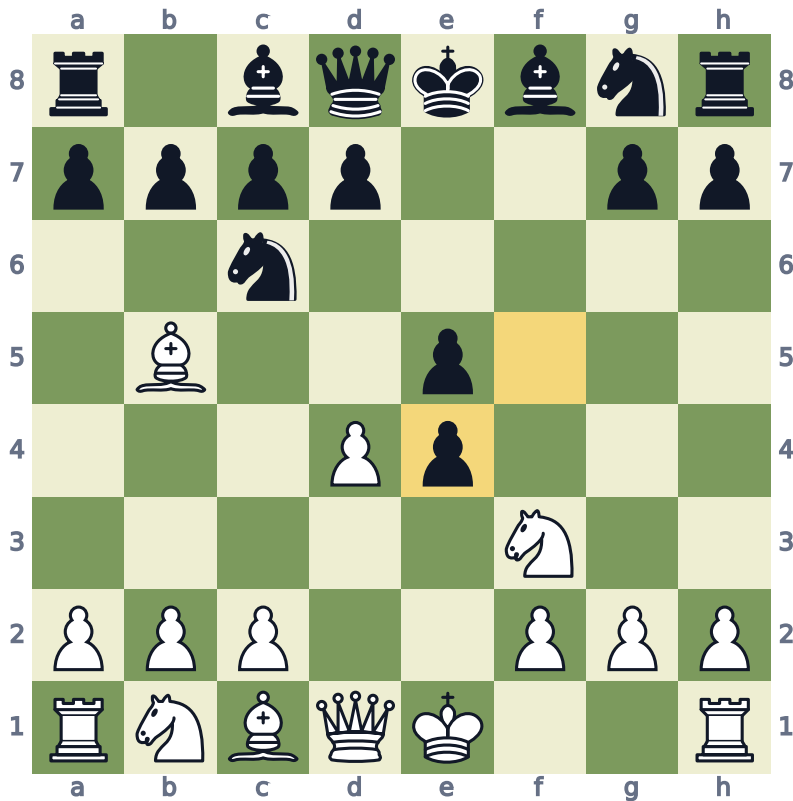
LESSON 084 | PAGE 24

Play: Classical 3...Bc5*Active development must anticipate the pawn moves that attack it.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will meet and use rare defenses with principled calculation rather than trap hunting.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Schliemann 3...f5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...f5 challenges e4 immediately and creates tactical imbalance, but weakens the king and e6 while development is incomplete.

DECISION RULE

After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Use the open f-file and central activity, develop quickly, and calculate checks before keeping extra material.

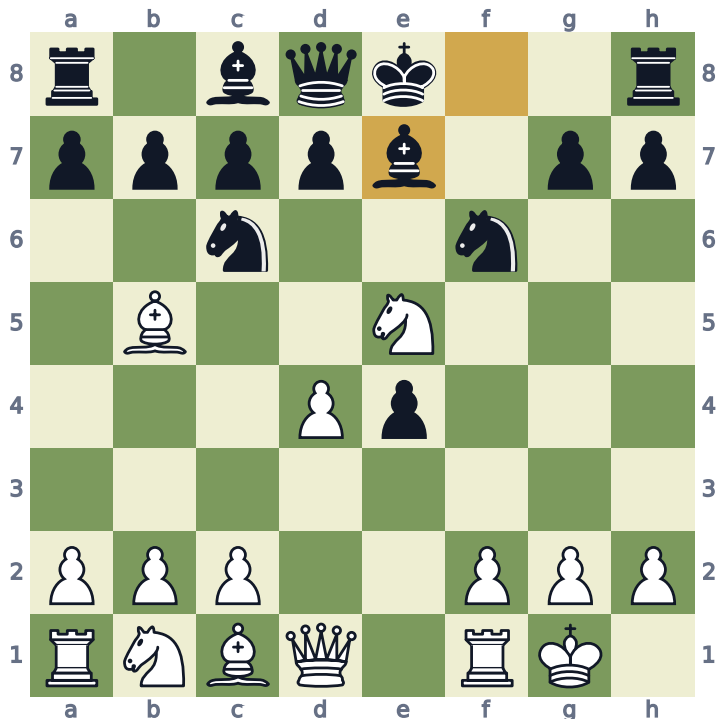
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White opens the center, targets the king, and uses rapid development against the weakened dark squares.

MEMORY RULE | A gambit defense succeeds through activity; if development stops, the weaknesses remain.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...f5 challenges e4 immediately and creates tactical imbalance, but weakens the king and e6 while development is incomplete.

BLACK'S PLAN

Use the open f-file and central activity, develop quickly, and calculate checks before keeping extra material.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White opens the center, targets the king, and uses rapid development against the weakened dark squares.

FAILURE MODE

Treating surprise value as compensation for a permanently exposed king.

DECISION TEST

Ask: After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

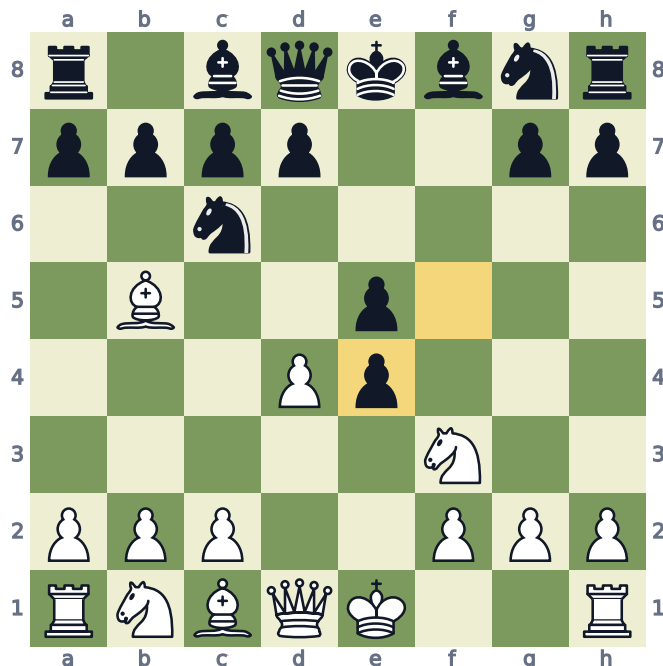
RULE | A gambit defense succeeds through activity; if development stops, the weaknesses remain.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 f5 4. d4 fxe4 5. Nxe5 Nf6 6. O-O Be7



- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bb5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- f5: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- fxe4: Black releases tension by capturing on e4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...f5 challenges e4 immediately and creates tactical imbalance, but weakens the king and e6 while development is incomplete.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line? White's resource is: White opens the center, targets the king, and uses rapid development against the weakened dark squares. The line fails as a template when: Treating surprise value as compensation for a permanently exposed king.

STORE THIS | A gambit defense succeeds through activity; if development stops, the weaknesses remain.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

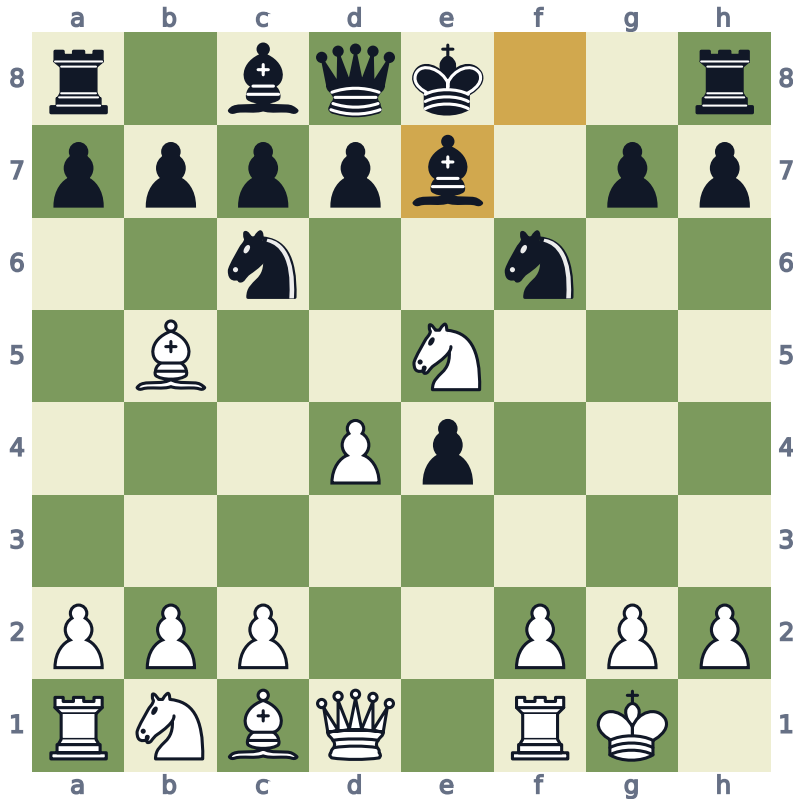
1. ...f5 challenges e4 immediately and creates tactical imbalance, but weakens the king and e6 while development is incomplete. 2. Use the open f-file and central activity, develop quickly, and calculate checks before keeping extra material. 3. White opens the center, targets the king, and uses rapid development against the weakened dark squares. 4. After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line? 5. Treating surprise value as compensation for a permanently exposed king.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 8 plies from memory, then replay: 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 f5 4. d4 fxe4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Schliemann 3...f5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...f5 challenges e4 immediately and creates tactical imbalance, but weakens the king and e6 while development is incomplete.

DECISION RULE

After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Use the open f-file and central activity, develop quickly, and calculate checks before keeping extra material.

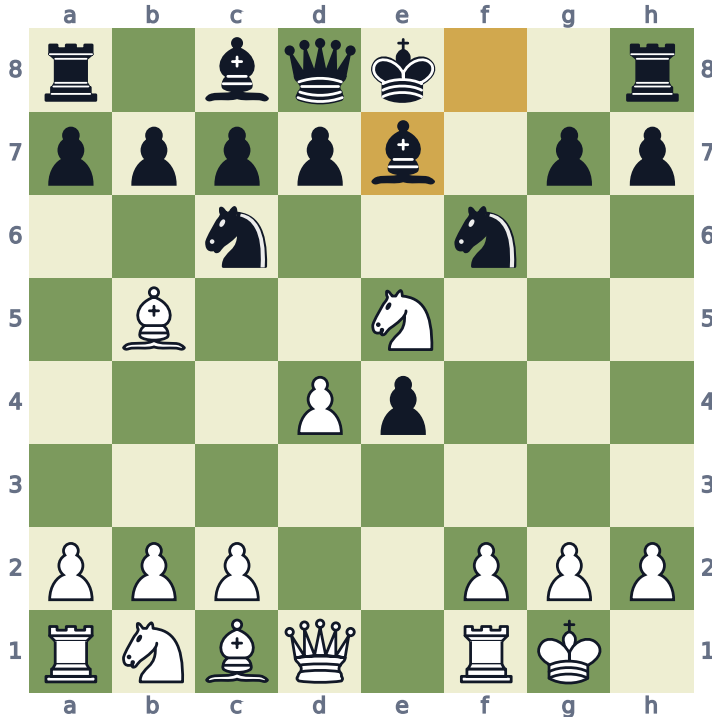
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...f5 challenges e4 immediately and creates tactical imbalance, but weakens the king and e6 while development is incomplete.

BLACK'S PLAN

Use the open f-file and central activity, develop quickly, and calculate checks before keeping extra material.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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White opens the center, targets the king, and uses rapid development against the weakened dark squares.

FAILURE MODE

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Ask: After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

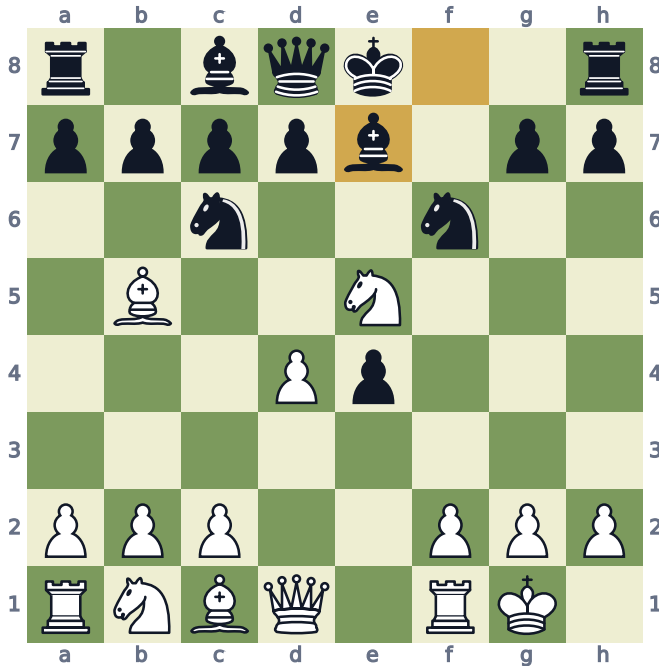
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 f5 4. d4 fxe4 5. Nxe5 Nf6 6. O-O Be7



- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- fxe4: Black releases tension by capturing on e4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nxe5: White releases tension by capturing on e5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...f5 challenges e4 immediately and creates tactical imbalance, but weakens the king and e6 while development is incomplete.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line? White's resource is: White opens the center, targets the king, and uses rapid development against the weakened dark squares. The line fails as a template when: Treating surprise value as compensation for a permanently exposed king.

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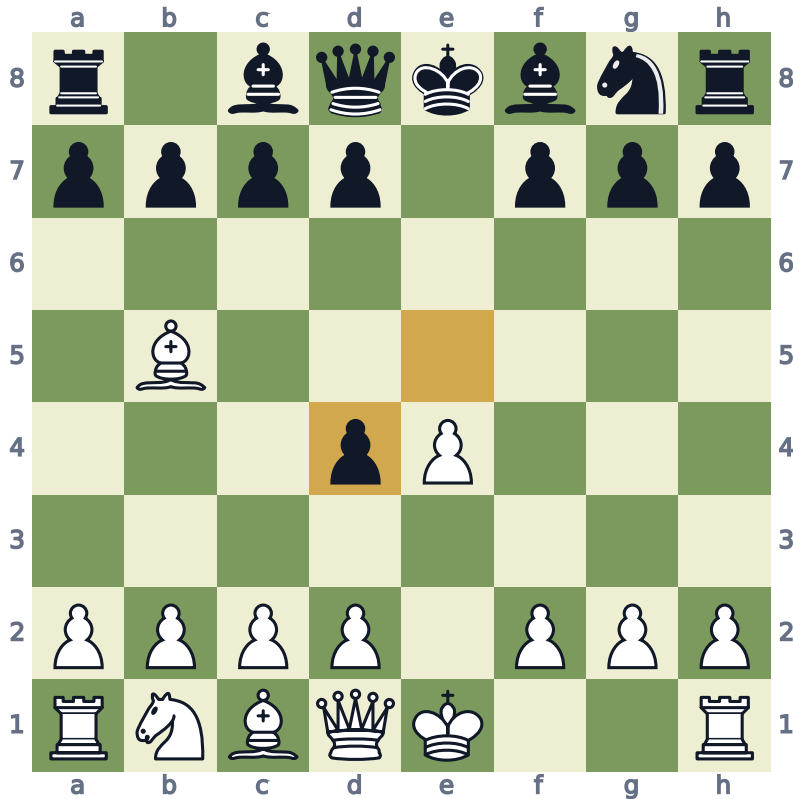
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. d4 fxe4 5. Nxe5 Nf6 6. O-O Be7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Bird Defense 3...Nd4



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Nd4 offers a structural transformation that gains central space but can leave the d4 pawn overextended and the c-pawn committed.

DECISION RULE

Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Use the space to develop with tempo, support or exchange the d4 pawn, and avoid a static target.

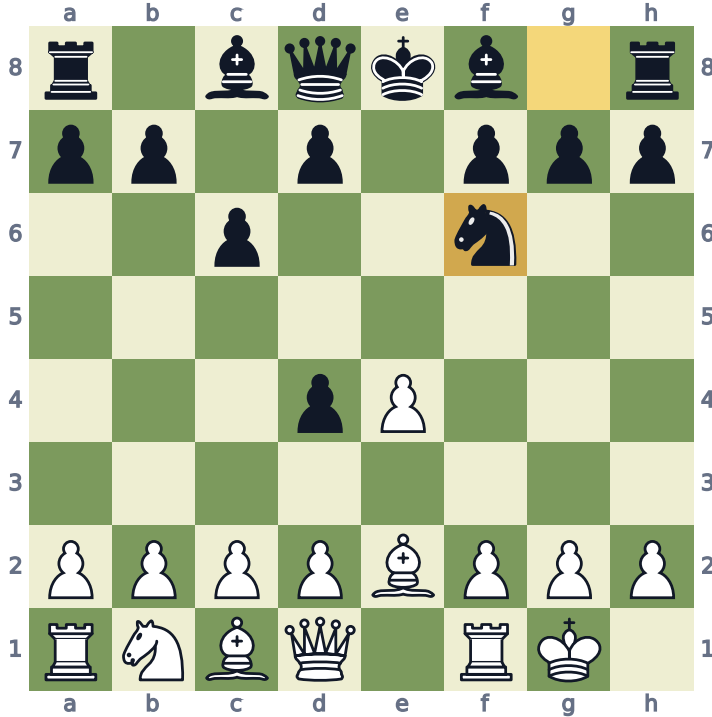
WHITE'S RESOURCES

White exchanges, attacks d4, and uses the open e-file plus faster castling.

MEMORY RULE | An advanced central pawn must restrict pieces or open lines; otherwise it is a target.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Nd4 offers a structural transformation that gains central space but can leave the d4 pawn overextended and the c-pawn committed.

BLACK'S PLAN

Use the space to develop with tempo, support or exchange the d4 pawn, and avoid a static target.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White exchanges, attacks d4, and uses the open e-file plus faster castling.

FAILURE MODE

Defending the advanced pawn with more pawn moves while falling behind in development.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

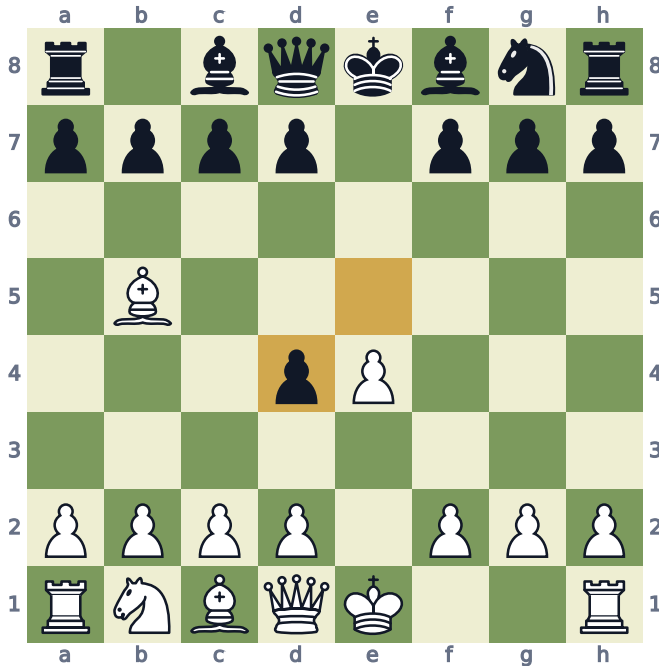
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Nd4 4. Nxd4 exd4 5. O-O c6 6. Be2 Nf6



- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bb5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nd4: Black reroutes a knight to d4; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- exd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Nd4 offers a structural transformation that gains central space but can leave the d4 pawn overextended and the c-pawn committed.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces? White's resource is: White exchanges, attacks d4, and uses the open e-file plus faster castling. The line fails as a template when: Defending the advanced pawn with more pawn moves while falling behind in development.

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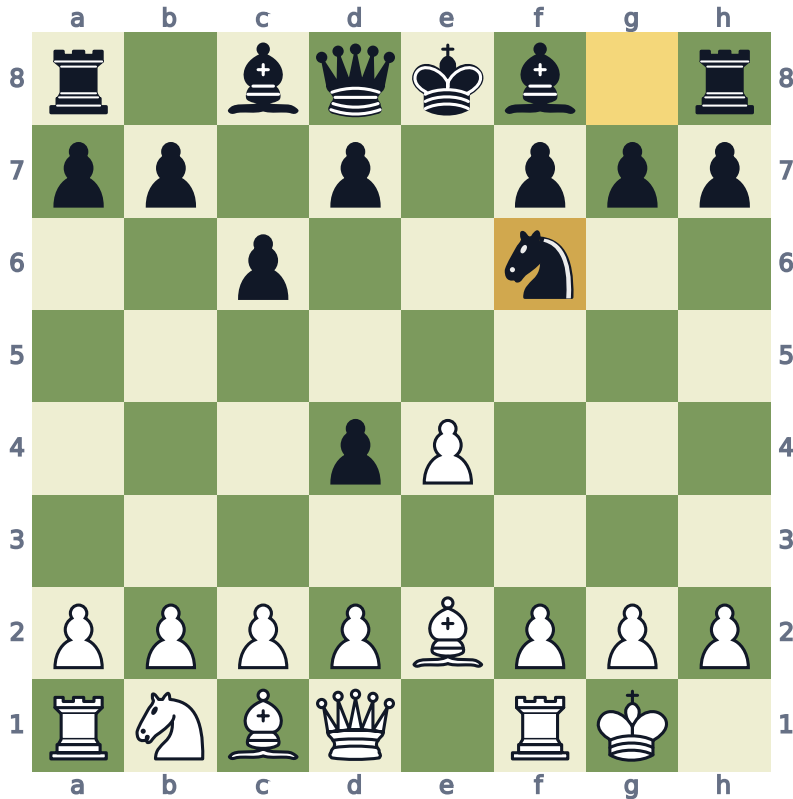
1. ...Nd4 offers a structural transformation that gains central space but can leave the d4 pawn overextended and the c-pawn committed. 2. Use the space to develop with tempo, support or exchange the d4 pawn, and avoid a static target. 3. White exchanges, attacks d4, and uses the open e-file plus faster castling. 4. Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces? 5. Defending the advanced pawn with more pawn moves while falling behind in development.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 8 plies from memory, then replay: 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Nd4 4. Nxd4 exd4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Bird Defense 3...Nd4



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Nd4 offers a structural transformation that gains central space but can leave the d4 pawn overextended and the c-pawn committed.

DECISION RULE

Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

Use the space to develop with tempo, support or exchange the d4 pawn, and avoid a static target.

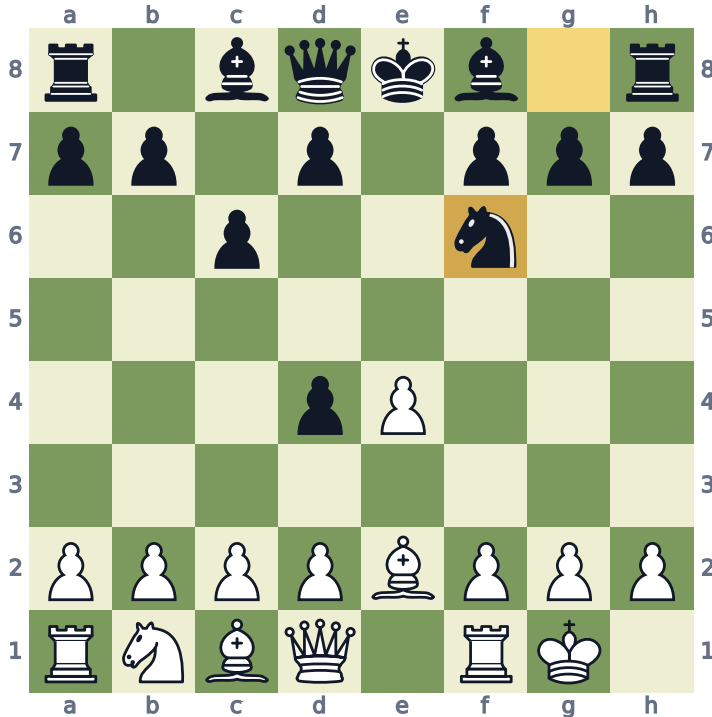
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White exchanges, attacks d4, and uses the open e-file plus faster castling.

MEMORY RULE | An advanced central pawn must restrict pieces or open lines; otherwise it is a target.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...Nd4 offers a structural transformation that gains central space but can leave the d4 pawn overextended and the c-pawn committed.

BLACK'S PLAN

Use the space to develop with tempo, support or exchange the d4 pawn, and avoid a static target.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S PLAN

White exchanges, attacks d4, and uses the open e-file plus faster castling.

FAILURE MODE

Defending the advanced pawn with more pawn moves while falling behind in development.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

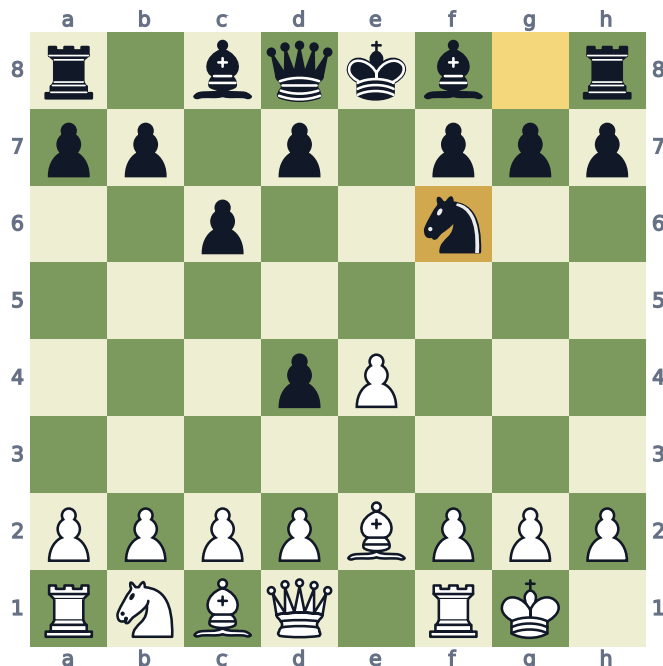
RULE | An advanced central pawn must restrict pieces or open lines; otherwise it is a target.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Nd4 4. Nxd4 exd4 5. O-O c6 6. Be2 Nf6



- Nxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- exd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- c6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Nd4 offers a structural transformation that gains central space but can leave the d4 pawn overextended and the c-pawn committed.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces? White's resource is: White exchanges, attacks d4, and uses the open e-file plus faster castling. The line fails as a template when: Defending the advanced pawn with more pawn moves while falling behind in development.

STORE THIS | An advanced central pawn must restrict pieces or open lines; otherwise it is a target.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

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4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

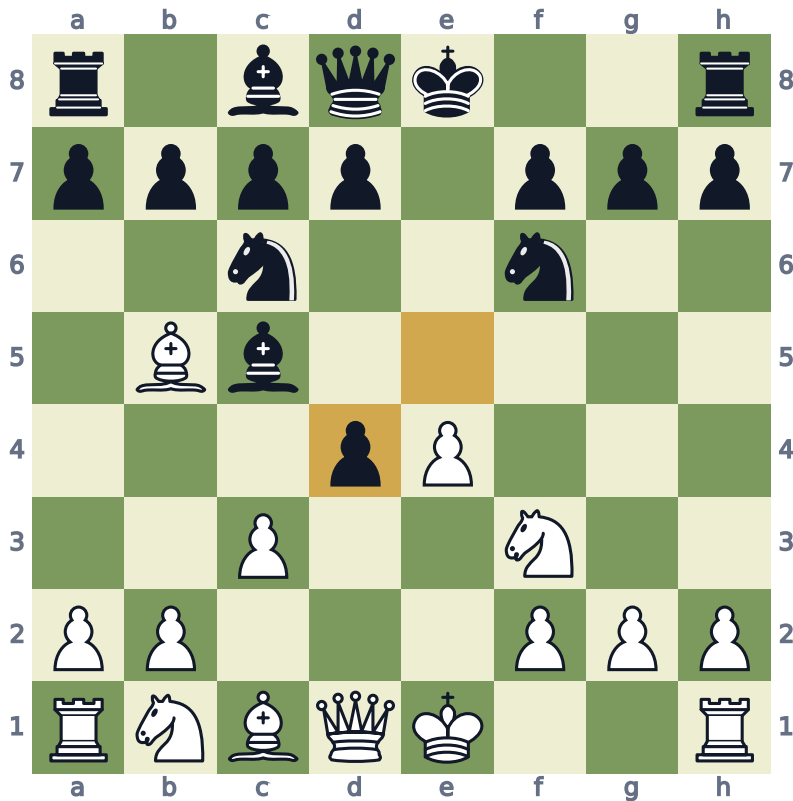
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. Nxd4 exd4 5. O-O c6 6. Be2 Nf6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Classical 3...Bc5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Bc5 develops actively and allows a more immediate central confrontation than the Morphy Defense.

DECISION RULE

After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

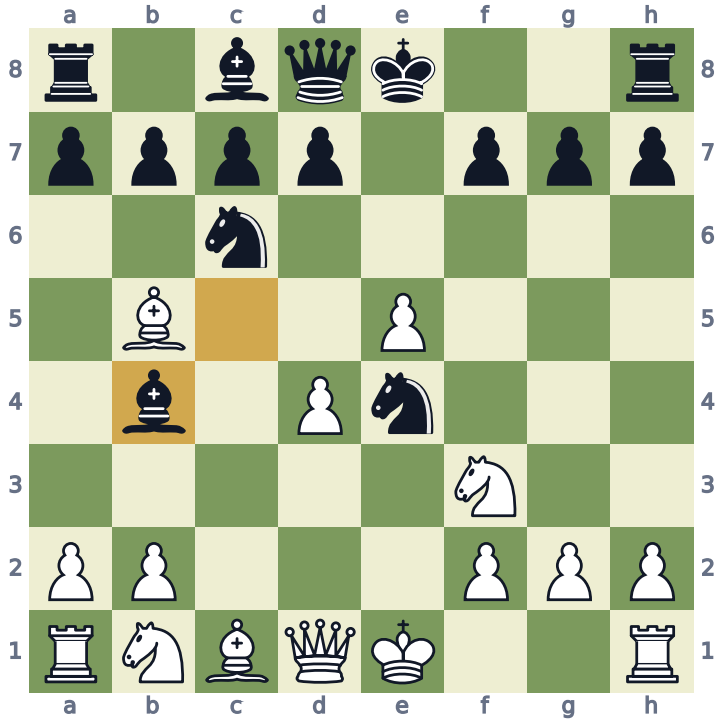
Use piece activity and tactical checks to meet d4; do not let the bishop become a target without compensation.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White builds c3-d4 with tempo and uses e5 to drive the f6 knight.

MEMORY RULE | Active development must anticipate the pawn moves that attack it.

The plan map



...Bc5 develops actively and allows a more immediate central confrontation than the Morphy Defense.

Use piece activity and tactical checks to meet d4; do not let the bishop become a target without compensation.

White

White builds c3-d4 with tempo and uses e5 to drive the f6 knight.

Leaving the bishop on c5 while White gains d4 and e5 with tempo.

Ask: After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative? Then compare at least two candidates against the opponent's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

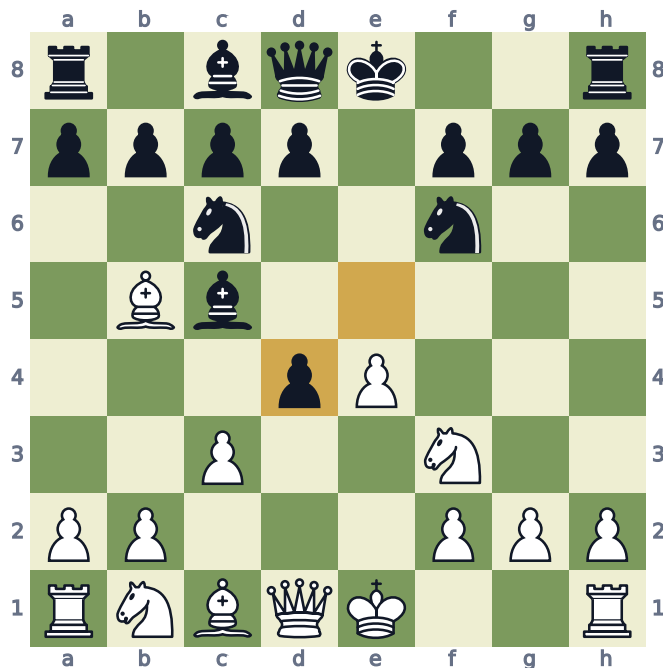
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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. e5 Ne4 7. cxd4 Bb4+



- Bb5: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Bc5: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- c3: White supports d4 and reserves c2 as a retreat square for the Spanish bishop.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- exd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...Bc5 develops actively and allows a more immediate central confrontation than the Morphy Defense.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative? White's resource is: White builds c3-d4 with tempo and uses e5 to drive the f6 knight. The line fails as a template when: Leaving the bishop on c5 while White gains d4 and e5 with tempo.

STORE THIS | Active development must anticipate the pawn moves that attack it.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

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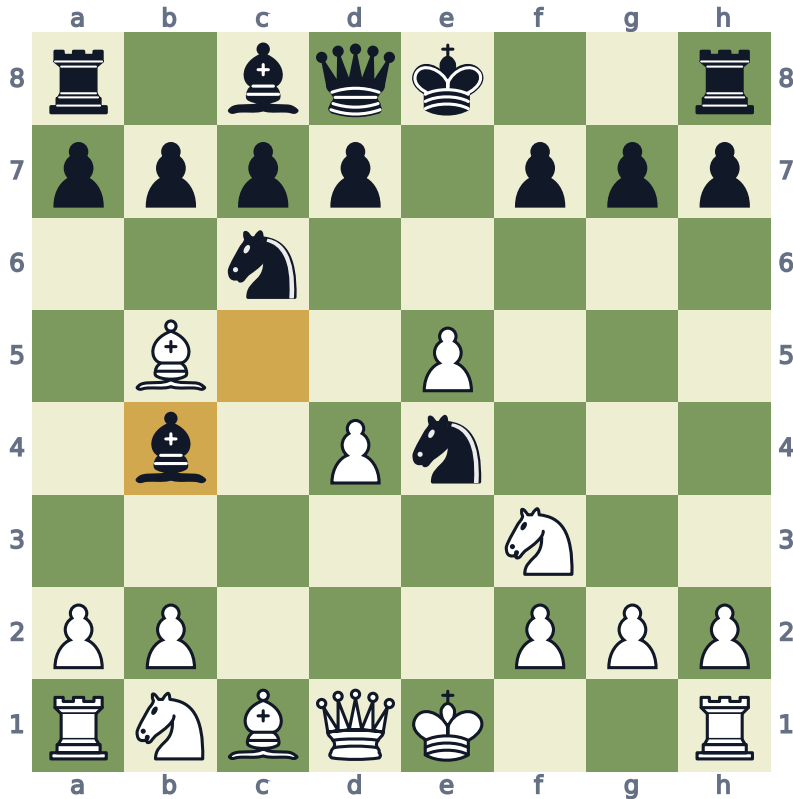
1. ...Bc5 develops actively and allows a more immediate central confrontation than the Morphy Defense. 2. Use piece activity and tactical checks to meet d4; do not let the bishop become a target without compensation. 3. White builds c3-d4 with tempo and uses e5 to drive the f6 knight. 4. After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative? 5. Leaving the bishop on c5 while White gains d4 and e5 with tempo.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. Bb5 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Classical 3...Bc5



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...Bc5 develops actively and allows a more immediate central confrontation than the Morphy Defense.

DECISION RULE

After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S RESOURCES

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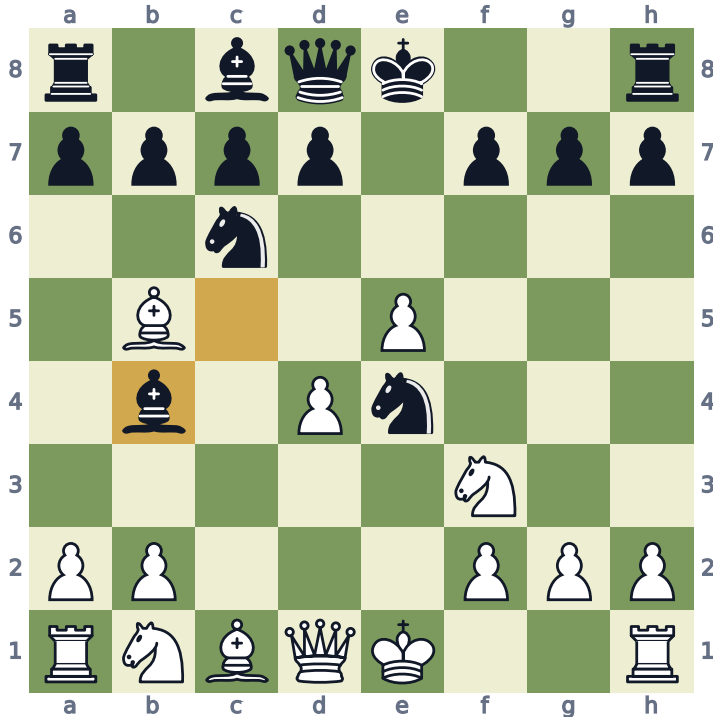
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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map

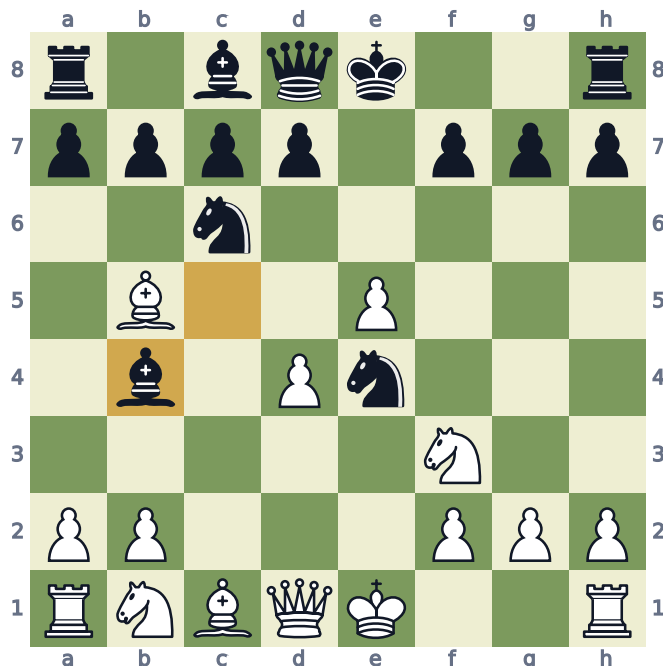


INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. e5 Ne4 7. cxd4 Bb4+



- d4: White challenges e5 and opens lines after the preparatory pieces are ready.
- exd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- e5: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Ne4: Black reroutes a knight to e4; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- cx d4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Bb4+: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

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After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative? White's resource is: White builds c3-d4 with tempo and uses e5 to drive the f6 knight. The line fails as a template when: Leaving the bishop on c5 while White gains d4 and e5 with tempo.

STORE THIS | Active development must anticipate the pawn moves that attack it.

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1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White trying to achieve, and which piece or pawn enables it?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. ...Bc5 develops actively and allows a more immediate central confrontation than the Morphy Defense. 2. Use piece activity and tactical checks to meet d4; do not let the bishop become a target without compensation. 3. White builds c3-d4 with tempo and uses e5 to drive the f6 knight. 4. After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative? 5. Leaving the bishop on c5 while White gains d4 and e5 with tempo.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. d4 exd4 6. e5 Ne4 7. cxd4 Bb4+

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 079 Decode: Schliemann 3...f5

Prompt: After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line?

Recall: A gambit defense succeeds through activity; if development stops, the weaknesses remain.

LESSON 080 Play: Schliemann 3...f5

Prompt: After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line?

Recall: A gambit defense succeeds through activity; if development stops, the weaknesses remain.

LESSON 081 Decode: Bird Defense 3...Nd4

Prompt: Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces?

Recall: An advanced central pawn must restrict pieces or open lines; otherwise it is a target.

LESSON 082 Play: Bird Defense 3...Nd4

Prompt: Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces?

Recall: An advanced central pawn must restrict pieces or open lines; otherwise it is a target.

LESSON 083 Decode: Classical 3...Bc5

Prompt: After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative?

Recall: Active development must anticipate the pawn moves that attack it.

LESSON 084 Play: Classical 3...Bc5

Prompt: After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative?

Recall: Active development must anticipate the pawn moves that attack it.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's plan, one candidate for the side to move, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

Schliemann 3...f5

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 f5 4. d4 fxe4 5. Nxe5 Nf6 6. O-O Be7

Decision: After ...f5, does Black have a safe king and enough development for every opened line?

Memory: A gambit defense succeeds through activity; if development stops, the weaknesses remain.

CARD 2

Bird Defense 3...Nd4

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Nd4 4. Nxd4 exd4 5. O-O c6 6. Be2 Nf6

Decision: Is the d4 pawn a space-gaining wedge or a target that blocks Black's own pieces?

Memory: An advanced central pawn must restrict pieces or open lines; otherwise it is a target.

CARD 3

Classical 3...Bc5

1. e4 e5 2. Nf3 Nc6 3. Bb5 Bc5 4. c3 Nf6 5. d4 exd4 6. e5 Ne4 7. cxd4 Bb4+

Decision: After White's central advance, which active check or capture preserves Black's initiative?

Memory: Active development must anticipate the pawn moves that attack it.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
079 Decode: Schliemann 3...f5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
080 Play: Schliemann 3...f5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
081 Decode: Bird Defense 3...Nd4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
082 Play: Bird Defense 3...Nd4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
083 Decode: Classical 3...Bc5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
084 Play: Classical 3...Bc5	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name both sides' strongest plans, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.